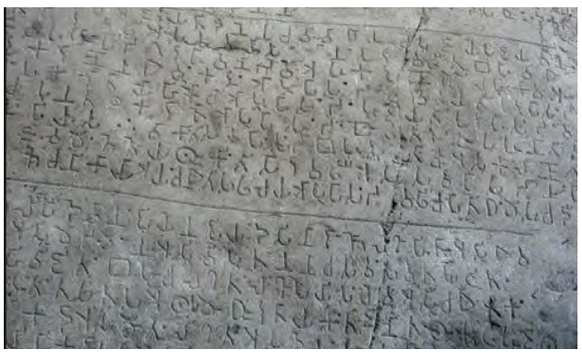
Saka rule was founded by Maos or Mogain in the Gandhara region and his capital was 'Sirkap'. His name is mentioned in Mora inscription. His coins bear images of Buddha and Siva.

Rudradaman was the most important and famous king of Sakas. His Junagadh/ Girnar inscription was the first inscription in chaste Sanskrit. In India, the Sakas were assimilated into Indian society. They began to adopt Indian names and practise Indian religious beliefs.



Junagadh Inscriptions



Coin of Rudradaman

The Sakas appointed kshatrapas or satraps as provincial governors to administer their territories.

Kushanas

The Kushanas formed a section of the yueh-chi tribes, who inhabited north-western China in the remote past. In the first century BC(BCE), the yueh-chi tribes were composed of five major sections, of which the Kushanas attained political ascendancy over others.

By the beginning of Christian era, all the yueh-chi tribes had acknowledged the supremacy of the Kushanas; they had shed their nomadic habits and settled down in the Bactrian and Parthian lands, adjacent to the north-western border of India.

The Kushanas overran Bactria and Parthia and gradually established themselves in northern India. Their concentration was mostly in the Punjab, Rajaputana and Kathiawar. Kushana rulers were Buddhists. Takshashila and Mathura continued to be great centres of Buddhist learning, attracting students from China and western Asia.

The Kushana Kings

Kanishka

Kanishka was the greatest of all the Kushana emperors. He assumed the sovereignty in 78 AD and proclaimed his rule by the foundation of a new era, which later became Saka era.

The Kushana capital initially was Kabul. Later, it was shifted to Peshavar or Purushpura.



Coin of Kanishka

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